



DOUG CLARKE

## Let's admire this Arte together

The word "hero," especially as it used in the sandbox world of sports, is like an old mine lying in the weeds. Best to just tiptoe around the thing and leave it well enough alone. Touch or fondle it at your own risk. It can only blow up in your face. If you want to find a real-life hero, go to Iraq or Afghanistan. The heroes are the ones in the camouflage outfits.

Insist on calling someone a "hero" in the world of sports? How about if we just settle for giving a guy a big, fat "Attaboy!" when he does something grand and let it go at that? Let's settle for that, shall we?

Today, I'm giving an "Attaboy!" to Arte Moreno.

Arte Moreno is the owner of the Los Angeles Angels of Anaheim. Or is it the other way around? I can never keep the name straight.

Putting the name "Los Angeles" in the team's name was a marketing move that Moreno made last year, infuriating the residents of Anaheim and confounding baseball fans and purists everywhere.

We gave Moreno neither an "Attaboy!" nor a gold star for that move. Turns out, though, that putting the "Los Angeles" in the club name made him and the Angels a bundle in marketing and advertising dollars, so it wasn't as wrong-headed a move as it seemed. From a financial and marketing standpoint, was a stroke of street smarts. Like the time Moreno, shortly after purchasing the Angels, lowered the price of beer at the ballpark. More street-smart savvy.

Now comes The Gary Matthews Jr. File, and while it isn't as gripping a tale as The Bourne Identity or The Ipcress File, it sure has the participants — which includes the smug and arrogant Players Union — on the edge of their seats. Everyone sitting there all edgy and nervous.

Except for Bud Selig, of course, who is somewhere on a beach in Florida, bent over at the waist, his head buried deep in the sand. He does this ostrich thing every time he hears the word "steroid." It has always been so.

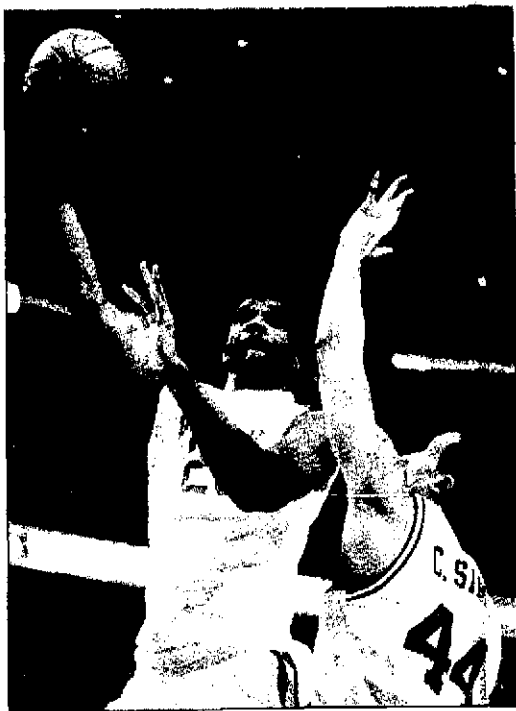
Truth to tell, you can usually find a whole flock of guys bent over at the waist with their heads buried in the sand, keeping Selig company. The flock of ostriches would be the baseball owners. Oh, the money they've made in baseball by playing ostrich this past decade or so to the debacle that is the "steroids issue."

Gary Matthews Jr. is the outfielder Moreno signed as a free agent to a fat, five-year contract over the winter. Matthews was coming off a career year in Texas and the Angels believed Matthews is — was — just the ticket to plug into their hole in center field.

Alas, Gary Matthews Jr. is also the ballplayer who was identified in a sting operation the feds ran in Albany, N.Y.

See CLARKE, C6

Ohio State's Greg Oden goes up for a hook shot against Michigan's Courtney Sims during the first half of the Buckeyes' 72-62 win in the Big Ten Tournament quarterfinals in Chicago on Friday. Oden scored 22 points.



NO. 1 OHIO STATE 72, MICHIGAN 62

## Not board with wins

Maria Ridenour  
McClatchy Newspapers

CHICAGO — It was an edge so amazing, Greg Oden had a hard time believing it.

Ohio State's 7-foot freshman center said he never had been on a team that was out-rebounded so badly.

In the first half of the quarterfinal game Friday in the Big Ten Tournament, Michigan claimed a 21-8 advantage on the boards. Those numbers and the presence of one of the most dominating defenders in college basketball do not seem to compute.

"I usually get more than eight

### TODAY

**WHO:** Ohio State vs. Purdue  
**WHAT:** Big Ten Tournament semifinal  
**WHERE:** United Center, Chicago  
**TIME:** 1:30 p.m.  
**TV/RADIO:** Channel 19; WEOL 930-AM, WKRN 850-AM

rebounds myself," Oden said.

Michigan finished with a plus-22 margin, third best in Big Ten Tournament history, but it wasn't enough to upset the nation's top-ranked team. Ohio State (28-3) set a school record for victories with a 72-62 deci-

sion at the United Center. OSU's previous high was 27 victories by the 1960-61 and 1990-91 teams.

Riding a 15-game winning streak, the Buckeyes take on fifth-seeded Purdue (21-10) in a semifinal game at 1:30 p.m. today. The Boilermakers advanced with a 74-55 triumph over Iowa.

Michigan (21-12) might have seen its hopes for an NCAA Tournament at-large bid wrecked by 32.7 percent shooting, 16 turnovers and Oden's first 20-point game since Jan. 20 (and only his fourth of the season).

See OSU, C4

## THE TOURNAMENT TRAIL: BOYS BASKETBALL



LINDA MURPHY / CHRONICLE

Olmsted Falls' Dave Pellerite cuts down the net after the Bulldogs' 56-50 win over Holy Name gave them the Division II district championship Friday night.

## A step forward

### District title nice, 'Dogs looking toward state

Roger Negin  
The Chronicle-Telegram

WESTLAKE — When speaking of its team goal, Olmsted Falls will not equivocate: The Bulldogs want to play in the state's Division II Final Four at Ohio State's Value City Arena.

Friday's 56-50 Bulldogs victory over Holy Name at Westlake High School in the district title game is just a step in that direction.

"Go in the (Falls) locker room," said coach Pat Donahue. "We've had Final Four

written on the board ever since we won the (Southwestern) Conference."

Tyler Sparks, who led all scorers with 25 points, backed up the coach.

"Our thing is set," he said. "We want to play in the Final Four. The rest will take care of itself."

The district title is the ninth for Olmsted Falls and Donahue, the first since 2004 when Sparks was a freshman, but getting through regional competition has been the problem.

See FALLS, C3

### INSIDE

#### 'HORNS HOOK DISTRICT CROWN:

Andrew Hofener scores 16 points in the second half as Lutheran West downs Chanel 71-64 to capture Division III title.

C3

### BROWNS

## Saying bye

### Droughns, McCutcheon no longer with the team

Scott Petrak  
The Chronicle-Telegram

BEREA — Running back Reuben Droughns and cornerback Daylon McCutcheon had productive years for the Browns in 2005.

After a disappointing 2006, both were sent packing Friday.

Such is life in the NFL, where the only thing more important than the latest performance is the size of the next check owed to the player.

Droughns, made expendable with the signing of Jamal Lewis on Wednesday, was traded to the New York Giants for fast but inconsistent receiver Tim Carter. The trade is pending both players passing physicals.

Droughns was due a \$1.75 million bonus next week and a \$1.25 million salary in 2007. If a trade hadn't been worked out, Droughns would've been released.

McCutcheon, 30, missed 2006 after a pair of knee surgeries. The Browns didn't think he would be able to help this year, so they terminated his contract. He was scheduled to make \$2.3 million in 2007.

See BROWNS, D2

### INDIANS

## Rivas in lead at utility infielder

Chris Assenheimer  
The Chronicle-Telegram

WINTER HAVEN, Fla. — The Indians' utility infielder battle is a four-horse race with just one thoroughbred at this point.

Luis Rivas, the former starting second baseman for the Minnesota Twins, is the early frontrunner for one of the last two roster spots on the club — the other in the bullpen — trying to fend off Joe Inglett, Hector Luna and Mike Rouse for a chance to resurrect his career.

Rivas, 27, was a mainstay at second for Minnesota during the team's Central Division championship seasons from 2002-04 before injuries sidetracked his career and left him lagging in the minors.

After signing with Tampa Bay last year, Rivas hit just .218 with two home runs and 24 RBIs, and committed 10 errors in 69 games for Triple-A Durham, never making an appearance in the majors.

"It's hard to get in shape and get back," Rivas said. "It was a bad experience. Now, I'm here again, and I'm going to try to get everything back to normal. I just want to play, that's all."

"So far, I think I'm doing the job."

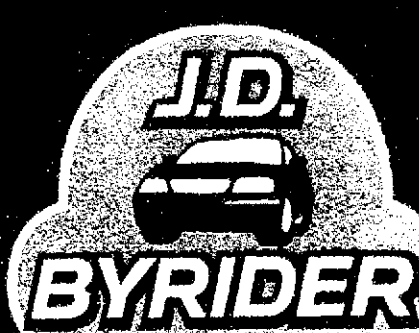
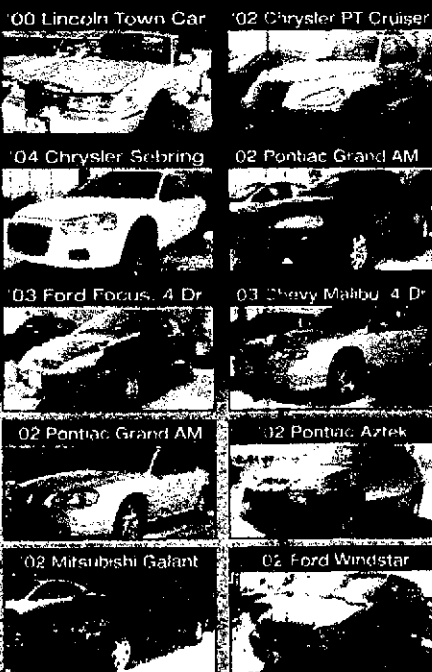
See TRIBE, D1

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